



Sony 4GB SDHC and microSDHC cards

or precious pictures in the card will go waste when after three months you find that the card isn't working. So if you are going to store something that's important, insist on genuineness and company warranty. Most fake cards are not supported by warranty.

If used carefully, the card should work for lifetime. But practically, this doesn't happen as people tend to expose them to high humidity or temperature.

What does the speed rating mean?

Speed rating refers to the transfer rate of data to/from a memory card. The speed class rating is the official unit of speed measurement for SD cards. It is equal to 8 Mbps, and it measures the minimum write speeds based on the best fragmented state where no memory unit is occupied.

The following are the ratings of some currently available cards:

1. Class 2: 16 Mbps (2 MB/s)
2. Class 4: 32 Mbps (4 MB/s)
3. Class 6: 48 Mbps (6 MB/s)
4. Class 10: 80 Mbps (10 MB/s)

To maximise the benefits, keep in mind that the device the memory card is paired with is able to write/read at the same speed as the card. If the digital device is not fast enough, the extra dash offered by a high-speed memory card won't help much.

Also, for a camera, speed rating of

the card should be chosen according to the resolution of the camera. High-megapixel cameras require a fast card to take in large images, so choose high maximum read/write speeds. If you use a high-megapixel camera with a standard-speed card, you may notice the time lag between pressing the shutter button and being able to take the next picture. This lag or delay, in most cases, is caused by a slow write speed. Similarly, copying your photos to your PC could take too much time due to a slow read speed.

How good are pre-bundled memory cards?

The problem with pre-bundled memory cards is that the end users may be thrown upon a card made by a less reliable maker that either comes with no or very poor warranty services

and period. Or for that matter, these pre-bundled cards could be of lesser storage capacity than that's possible within that device—just to keep the price of the bundled offer within the limit. Therefore use cards of leading brands even if you are getting one in a bundled deal.

Do's and don'ts

1. Always check the format supported by your device before purchasing the memory card. For example, a device

that is microSD-compatible cannot use an SDHC card.

2. Always take note of the speed class of the cards you are buying. A minimum Class 4 card is required to take HD videos. By using a lower-speed card (Class 2), you may risk loss of data during recording, resulting in a poorly taken video with frame/sound lost.

3. Buy branded memory cards according to the requirement to prevent any damage to the device.

4. Don't buy a higher-capacity memory card just to impress your peers. You

may not use even a fraction of the space available.

5. Keep the card in the mini case provided.

6. Don't leave your camera or the card in the car especially in summer time, as the plastic part may not withstand very high temperature. A very high temperature can affect the product's functions and spoil the card too. Read the temperature instructions by the manufacturers carefully.

7. Don't remove the card when a photo is being processed or music is being played. When the card is used along with a card reader, always click 'safe to remove hardware' before unplugging the card from the reader. Otherwise, there are chances of the card getting spoiled. ●

The author is a deputy editor at EPY